

Οἰνόμαος ὁ Γαδαρεύς

## Oenomaus of Gadara and the Fragments Against Oracles

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**Period:** Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)  
**Dialect:** Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)  
**Domain:** Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)  
**Format:** Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)  
**Affiliation:** [Cynic](#)

Oenomaus of Gadara was a Cynic philosopher who lived in the 2nd century CE during the Roman Empire. He came from the city of Gadara, a Hellenistic cultural center in the Decapolis region. Beyond this, few specific details of his life are known.

His significance lies primarily in his written attack on traditional Greek religion. His major work was titled *Goêtes*, or *The Charlatans*, a polemical treatise criticizing oracular divination. In it, he argued that the famous oracles, particularly that of Apollo at Claros, were not divine but were run by human fraudsters who gave ambiguous and misleading prophecies. This vigorous critique of religious institutions and practices was characteristic of the Cynic school's challenge to social conventions.

The survival of his ideas is largely due to the Christian writer Eusebius of Caesarea, who quoted long fragments of Oenomaus's work in the 4th century CE. Eusebius used these excerpts to support early Christian arguments against pagan religion. Consequently, Oenomaus's philosophical critique later served as a source for Christian apologetics, preserving his thought for later generations.

### Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Χρηστηρίων · [Fragments Against Oracles](#) · 29 passages

### Other Cynic Authors

- Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Antisthenes of Athens I](#) · 1 work
- Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Antisthenes of Athens II](#) · 2 works
- Βίων ὁ Βορυσθενίτης · [Bion of Borysthenes](#) · 2 works
- Κράτης ὁ Θεβαῖος · [Crates of Thebes I](#) · 1 work
- Δημόναξ ὁ Κύπριος · [Demonax of Cyprus](#) · 1 work
- Διογένης ὁ Σινωπεύς · [Diogenes of Sinope](#) · 1 work
- Διοτογένης ὁ φιλόσοφος · [Diotogenes the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Μόνιμος ὁ Συρακόσιος · [Monimus of Syracuse](#) · 1 work
- Νίκαρχος ὁ Σινωπεύς · [Nikarchos of Sinope](#) · 1 work
- Σεκούνδος ὁ Σιωπηλός · [Secundus the Silent](#) · 2 works
- Τέλης ὁ Μεγαρεύς · [Teles of Megara](#) · 8 works